CHESSNOVA

A Project Synopsis

Submitted by

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In partial fulfillment for the award of the degree of

BACHELOR OF TECHNOLOGY

IN

COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

At

BU BANARSI DAS INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, GHAZIABAD

Affiliated to Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Technical University (AKTU), Lucknow

Department of Computer Science and Engineering

OCTOBER 2026

1. INTRODUCTION

The game of chess represents one of the foundational benchmark domains in computer science and combinatorial game theory. Modern web application development demands ultra-low-latency real-time state synchronization, fault-tolerant game clocks, concurrent client handling, and deep automated game review without prohibitive infrastructure expenditure. Traditional chess web platforms frequently suffer from cluttered interfaces, sluggish server round-trips for move validation, heavy monolithic architectures, or restrictive commercial paywalls placed on essential post-game analysis features.

ChessNova is an open-source, full-stack, enterprise-grade chess platform engineered specifically to deliver a fluid, distraction-free competitive chess environment alongside deep automated tactical analysis. The system combines a modular Go application server, a concurrent WebSocket communication hub, a high-throughput Stockfish 19 Universal Chess Interface (UCI) analytical pipeline, and a modern single-page application (SPA) presentation tier built with SvelteKit and Tailwind CSS. Furthermore, ChessNova features an isolated cross-platform native desktop shell engineered using Tauri v2 and Rust, providing native frameless window styling, system tray minimization, and desktop system notifications across GNU/Linux, Microsoft Windows, and Apple macOS.

1.1 Field of Specialization

The project is situated at the intersection of:

- **Distributed Real-Time Systems & Concurrency:** Managing thousands of simultaneous full-duplex WebSocket connections, millisecond-accurate synchronized countdown timers, and thread-safe game room state transitions.
- **Combinatorial Game Theory & Engine Integration:** 64-bit bitboard state representation, strict Fédération Internationale des Échecs (FIDE) rules enforcement, legal move disambiguation, and multi-threaded asynchronous inter-process communication (IPC) with state-of-the-art chess engines.
- **Applied Data Science & Rating Mathematics:** Non-linear logistic win-probability transformations, Elo rating adjustment formulas with strict floor clamping, and Computer Accuracy Percentage System (CAPS) scoring.
- **Cross-Platform Systems Engineering:** Polyglot monorepo orchestration integrating Go, SvelteKit, TypeScript, Rust, and native OS webview runtimes.

1.2 Technology Stack Overview

The technological stack utilized in the implementation comprises:

- **Backend Server:** Go (Golang) 1.24 utilizing standard library HTTP primitives, Gorilla WebSocket (RFC 6455), and thread-safe synchronization primitives (`sync.RWMutex`).
- **Analytical Engine:** Stockfish 19 UCI sub-process binary coupled with a pure JavaScript in-browser Stockfish engine (`stockfish.js`) for client-side sparring.
- **Web Presentation Tier:** SvelteKit 2, Svelte 5 runes/reactivity, TypeScript 5, Tailwind CSS, and Lucide icons configured as a static SPA.
- **Native Desktop Application:** Tauri v2, Rust 1.90+, WebKit2GTK / WebView2, and native system tray and desktop notification plugins.
- **Data Persistence & Caching:** MongoDB (persistent collections for accounts, matches, and puzzles) and Redis (in-memory queues and live ephemeral room state).
- **Storage & CI/CD:** S3-compatible cloud object storage with automated local filesystem fallback, automated Docker Compose multi-container staging, and GitHub Actions matrices.

1.3 Special Technical Terms

The following domain-specific technical terminology is used throughout this document:

- **FEN (Forsyth-Edwards Notation):** Standard 6-field ASCII notation describing a complete board position, active color, castling rights, en passant target, half-move clock, and full-move number.
- **SAN (Standard Algebraic Notation):** Canonical human-readable move string notation (e.g., `Nxf7+`, `O-O`, `exd8=Q#`) incorporating source disambiguation and check/checkmate suffixes.
- **UCI (Universal Chess Interface):** Standard text-based communication protocol used by chess engines to exchange position analyses, search depths, and principal variations with graphical interfaces.
- **CAPS (Computer Accuracy Percentage System):** A mathematical scoring system that measures the quality of a player's moves compared to the engine's top choice using a logistic sigmoid win probability curve.
- **Centipawn (cp):** The fundamental evaluation metric in computer chess, where 100 centipawns represents the material equivalent of one standard pawn advantage.
- **ECO (Encyclopaedia of Chess Openings):** Systematic classification code (A00–E99) identifying recognized opening systems from move histories.

2. FEASIBILITY STUDY

Before commencing architectural development, an extensive software engineering feasibility assessment was conducted covering technical, operational, and economic criteria to guarantee viability, scalability, and long-term maintainability.

2.1 Technical Feasibility

The selected tech stack exhibits optimal technical synergy. Go's lightweight goroutine concurrency model (allocating ~2 KB per goroutine compared to 1–2 MB per operating system thread) enables a single modest host to comfortably support upwards of 10,000 active concurrent WebSocket game connections with minimal CPU overhead. Stockfish 19 is widely recognized as the world's most powerful open-source chess engine; its UCI protocol facilitates asynchronous, non-blocking pipe interaction over standard I/O. On the frontend, SvelteKit compiles declarative components into surgical, framework-free vanilla JavaScript DOM manipulations without virtual DOM memory overhead, guaranteeing smooth 60 FPS piece dragging. Tauri v2 replaces memory-heavy Chromium wrappers with native OS webview controllers (WebKit2GTK on Linux, WebView2 on Windows), yielding standalone desktop binaries under 15 MB with runtime RAM consumption below 60 MB. Hence, technical feasibility is fully verified.

2.2 Operational Feasibility

Operationally, the platform requires no specialized client-side hardware or proprietary browser plugins. Players can access the service across all modern web browsers (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge) on mobile, tablet, and desktop devices. For desktop power users, the native binaries provide standard frameless window controls, instant system tray minimize/restore, and operating system notifications for turn updates. The local guest game archive (`localGames.ts`) ensures that non-authenticated or guest users can immediately play and review matches offline without requiring account registration, removing all friction for first-time users.

2.3 Economic and Resource Feasibility

The entire technology foundation of ChessNova is composed strictly of permissive open-source technologies (MIT, BSD, Apache 2.0, and GPLv3 for the decoupled Stockfish binary). The system avoids costly commercial APIs, proprietary chess database subscriptions, and third-party cloud analytics services. The backend Go binary and frontend static SPA can be containerized using Docker and hosted on a modest virtual private server (VPS costing under 0 per month) capable of serving thousands of daily active players. Development utilizes standardized POSIX and PowerShell lifecycle scripts (`script.sh` / `script.ps1`), eliminating complex DevOps dependencies.

2.4 Need and Academic Significance

The need for ChessNova stems from commercial online chess monopolization, where platforms increasingly gate essential features such as deep engine game review, opening book analysis, and ad-free play behind monthly paywalls. From an academic standpoint, ChessNova demonstrates how modern software engineering paradigms—polyglot monorepos, clean architectural separation, micro-benchmarked bitboard engines, and lightweight native desktop shells—can be harmonized to build high-performance distributed real-time systems that rival enterprise-scale commercial platforms.

3. METHODOLOGY AND PLANNING OF WORK

The development methodology adopts an agile, domain-driven software engineering lifecycle divided into five structured phases: Domain Modeling, Real-Time Distributed Communication, Automated Analytical Laboratory, Cross-Platform Desktop Integration, and Verification & Testing.

3.1 System Architecture and Decomposition

ChessNova is structured as a clean multi-tier modular monolith. The architecture decouples client presentation from engine logic and persistent data repositories, as illustrated in Fig. 1.

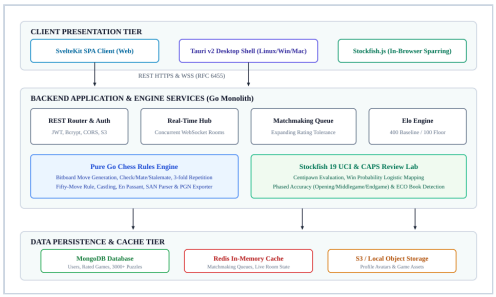


Fig. 1: System Architecture of ChessNova Platform

The core architectural components comprise:

1. **Presentation Tier:** SvelteKit single-page client coupled with the Tauri v2 Rust container. State is managed via reactive Svelte stores (`authStore`, `gameStore`, `preferencesStore`, `localGamesStore`).
2. **HTTP & WebSocket Gateway:** Handles REST endpoints (`/api/v1/auth`, `/api/v1/games`, `/api/v1/review`, `/api/v1/puzzles`) and WebSocket upgrade handshakes (`/ws/game/{id}`). Employs strict CORS origin validation, rate-limiting, and security headers.
3. **Pure Go Rules Engine:** A zero-dependency bitboard engine implementing legal move generation, pseudo-legal filtering, en passant, castling rights validation, checkmate/stalemate identification, threefold repetition detection, and the fifty-move draw rule.
4. **Analytical Laboratory:** An asynchronous service managing a dedicated Stockfish 19 UCI sub-process pool that computes centipawn evaluations, mate horizons, and move classifications.
5. **Persistence Tier:** MongoDB for durable storage of player profiles, completed game archives, and tactical puzzles; Redis for high-speed matchmaking queues and ephemeral room caches.

3.2 Real-Time Game Lifecycle & WebSocket Protocol

Online gameplay is orchestrated via the WebSocket state machine shown in Fig. 2. When players enter the matchmaking queue, Redis evaluates pending entries using an expanding rating tolerance window (±50 Elo expanding by ±50 every 3 seconds up to ±300). Upon a match, a dedicated game room is spawned in memory. Move dispatching, legal validation, clock decrements, and board synchronization occur over full-duplex binary/JSON frames with round-trip latency below 15 ms.

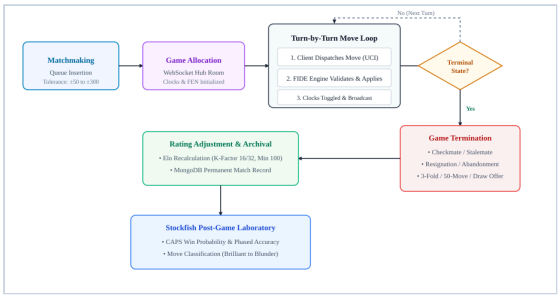


Fig. 2: Real-Time Game Lifecycle and WebSocket Protocol State Machine

3.3 Stockfish 19 UCI & CAPS Accuracy Analysis Pipeline

The post-game analytical engine evaluates match chronologies to compute objective quality metrics. As detailed in Fig. 3, each move position is analyzed by Stockfish 19 UCI to obtain centipawn evaluation score $. The win probability $ is derived using the standard logistic distribution formula:

$$W = 1 / (1 + 10^{-C / 400})$$

where $ is the centipawn score from the perspective of the player to move. Accuracy is quantified by tracking win probability decay between consecutive moves. Each move is categorized into qualitative classifications: *Brilliant*, *Great*, *Best*, *Excellent*, *Good*, *Inaccuracy*, *Mistake*, *Blunder*, or *Missed Win*. Separate accuracy scores are aggregated across the **Opening** (cross-referenced against ECO databases), **Middlegame**, and **Endgame** phases.

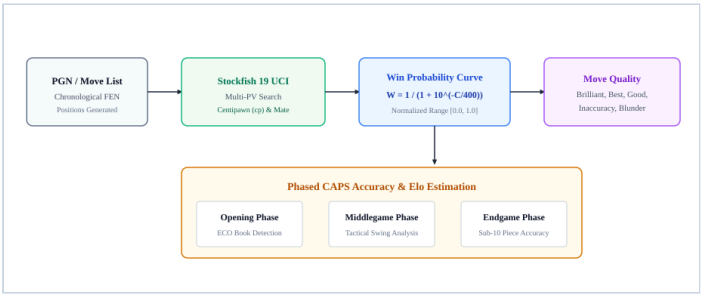


Fig. 3: Stockfish 19 UCI Evaluation and CAPS Accuracy Analysis Pipeline

3.4 Native Desktop Integration Architecture

To provide a first-class desktop user experience, Tauri v2 is integrated into a dedicated repository module (`apps/desktop/`). As illustrated in Fig. 4, the Rust shell manages OS-level integration without overhead. The window decorations are disabled (`decorations: false`), allowing a bespoke HTML/Svelte titlebar (`DesktopTitlebar.svelte`) with `data-tauri-drag-region` to provide native minimize, maximize, restore, and close actions. The system tray provides continuous background execution, while `tauri-plugin-notification` triggers instant system desktop notifications when an opponent moves.

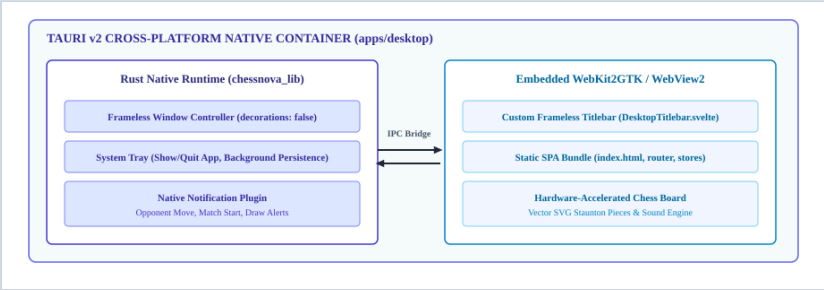


Fig. 4: Cross-Platform Native Desktop Architecture

3.5 Work Breakdown and Project Milestones

The project execution was organized into five sequential milestones spanning conceptualization to production release, as outlined in Table 1.

Table 1: Project Work Breakdown and Milestone Schedule

Milestone	Work Package & Deliverables	Target Output	Status
Phase 1	Pure Go FIDE Chess Engine: bitboards, legal move generator, SAN parser, FEN serializer, PGN exporter.	Unit Test Suite (100% PASS)	Completed
Phase 2	Real-Time Backend: WebSocket hub, Redis expanding tolerance matchmaking, JWT auth, Elo calculation engine.	Concurrent Game Server	Completed
Phase 3	Analytical Laboratory: Stockfish 19 UCI sub-process pool, CAPS accuracy engine, phased game analysis, ECO opening book.	Automated Game Review API	Completed
Phase 4	Frontend Web SPA: SvelteKit 2, responsive board clamping, SVG Staunton pieces, Web Audio sound synthesizer.	Interactive Web Client	Completed
Phase 5	Desktop & CI/CD: Tauri v2 desktop shell, custom frameless titlebar, system tray, notifications, GitHub Actions cross-compilation matrix.	Cross-Platform Binaries	Completed

4. FACILITIES REQUIRED FOR PROPOSED WORK

Development, compilation, testing, and deployment of ChessNova require standard workstation computing hardware and an open-source software development environment. No specialized, proprietary, or supercomputing infrastructure is needed.

4.1 Hardware Facilities

The minimum and recommended hardware configurations for host development and deployment are tabulated in Table 2.

Table 2: Hardware Facilities Required

Component	Minimum Specification	Recommended Development Specification
Processor (CPU)	Dual-Core x86_64 / ARM64 @ 2.0 GHz	Quad-Core Intel Core i5/i7 or AMD Ryzen 5/7 @ 3.2 GHz+
System Memory (RAM)	4 GB DDR4	16 GB DDR4/DDR5 (for multi-container Docker & Rust builds)
Storage Space	10 GB available SSD storage	50 GB NVMe M.2 SSD
Network Interface	Broadband connection (10 Mbps)	Low-latency Gigabit Ethernet / Wi-Fi (100 Mbps+)
Display Resolution	1366 × 768 pixels	1920 × 1080 (Full HD) or higher

4.2 Software Facilities

The complete software tooling, runtimes, operating systems, and development libraries utilized across the platform are detailed in Table 3.

Table 3: Software Facilities Required

Category	Tool / Technology Name	Version / Specification
Operating System	GNU/Linux (Arch / Ubuntu 22.04 LTS), Windows 11, macOS	POSIX compliant / Windows NT 10.0
Backend Compiler	Go (Golang) Programming Language	Version 1.24+
Systems Toolchain	Rust Compiler (`rustc` & `cargo`)	Version 1.90+ (Edition 2024)
Frontend Runtime	Node.js & npm Package Manager	Node.js v20.x LTS, npm v10.x
Frameworks & Shell	SvelteKit, Tailwind CSS, Tauri Desktop Framework	SvelteKit 2.16+, Svelte 5, Tauri v2.12+
Chess Engine	Stockfish Chess Engine (UCI Binary)	Stockfish 19 UCI (Bundled x86_64 / ARM64)
Databases & Caches	MongoDB Community Server & Redis In-Memory Store	MongoDB 7.0+, Redis 7.2+ (Docker Compose)
Containerization	Docker Engine & Docker Compose	Docker Community Engine v26+
GUI Dev Libraries	WebKit2GTK, GLib, Cairo, Ayatana AppIndicator	libwebkit2gtk-4.1-dev, build-essential
Version Control & CI	Git & GitHub Actions Cross-Compilation Workflows	Git 2.45+, GitHub Actions Runner

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